

**CARIBBEAN EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL****CARIBBEAN SECONDARY EDUCATION CERTIFICATE®
EXAMINATION****ENGLISH B****Paper 01 – General Proficiency***1 hour 45 minutes***READ THE FOLLOWING INSTRUCTIONS CAREFULLY.**

1. This paper consists of THREE questions. Each question is worth 20 marks.
2. Answer ALL questions.
3. Write your answers in the spaces provided in this answer booklet.
4. Do NOT write in the margins.
5. You are advised to take some time to read through the paper and plan your answers.
6. If you need to rewrite any answer and there is not enough space to do so on the original page, you must use the extra lined page(s) provided at the back of this booklet. **Remember to draw a line through your original answer.**
7. **If you use the extra page(s) you MUST write the question number clearly in the box provided at the top of the extra page(s) and, where relevant, include the question part beside the answer.**

DO NOT TURN THIS PAGE UNTIL YOU ARE TOLD TO DO SO.

SECTION A – DRAMA

1. Read the following extract carefully and answer ALL the questions that follow.

The action takes place in the home of Mrs Wright who has been taken into custody.

MRS HALE: *(Examining another section of Mrs Wright's quilt.)* Mrs Peters, look at this one. Here, this is the one she was working on, and look at the sewing! All the rest of it has been so nice and even. And look at this! It's all over the place! Why, it looks as if she didn't know what she was about! *(After she has said this, they look at each other, then start to glance back at the door. After an instant Mrs Hale has pulled at the knot and ripped the sewing.)*

MRS PETERS: Oh, what are you doing, Mrs Hale?

MRS HALE: *(Mildly.)* Just pulling out a stitch or two that's not sewed very good. *(Threading a needle.)* Bad sewing always made me fidgety.

MRS PETERS: *(Nervously.)* I don't think we ought to touch things.

MRS HALE: I'll just finish up this end. *(Suddenly stopping and leaning forward.)* Mrs Peters?

MRS PETERS: Yes, Mrs Hale?

MRS HALE: What do you suppose she was so nervous about?

MRS PETERS: Oh — I don't know. I don't know if she was nervous. I sometimes sew awful queer when I'm just tired. *(Mrs Hale starts to say something, looks at Mrs Peters, then goes on sewing.)* Well, I must get these things wrapped up. They may be through sooner than we think. *(Putting apron and other things together.)* I wonder where I can find a piece of paper, and string.

MRS HALE: In that cupboard, maybe.

MRS PETERS: *(Looking in cupboard.)* Why here's a birdcage. *(Holds it up.)* Did she have a bird, Mrs Hale?

MRS HALE: Why, I don't know whether she did or not — I've not been here for so long. There was a man around last year selling canaries cheap, but I don't know if she took one; maybe she did. She used to sing real pretty herself.

MRS PETERS: *(Glancing around.)* Seems funny to think of a bird here. But she must have had one, or why should she have a cage? I wonder what happened to it.

MRS HALE: I s'pose maybe the cat got it.

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE



- 30 MRS PETERS: No she didn't have a cat. She's got that feeling some people have about cats — being afraid of them. My cat got in her room, and she was real upset and asked me to take it out. (*Examining the cage.*) Why, look at this door. It's broke. One hinge is pulled apart.
- 35 MRS HALE: (*Looking too.*) Looks as if someone must have been rough with it. (*Dropping her sewing.*) But I tell you what I do wish, Mrs Peters. I wish I had come over sometimes when she was here. I (*looking around the room*) wish I had. I can see now (*Shakes her head.*).
- MRS HALE: Did you know John Wright, Mrs Peters?
- MRS PETERS: Not to know him; I've seen him in town. They say he was a good man.
- 40 MRS HALE: But he was a hard man; Mrs Peters. Just to pass the time of day with him. (*Shivers.*) Like a raw wind that gets to the bone. (*Pauses, her eye falling on the cage.*) I should think she would'a wanted a bird. But what do you suppose went with it?
- MRS PETERS: I don't know, unless it got sick and died. (*She reaches over and swings the broken door, swings it again; both women watch it.*)
- 45 MRS HALE: She — come to think of it, she was kind of like a bird herself — real sweet and pretty, but kind of timid and fluttery. How — she — did — change. (*Silence; then as if struck by a happy thought and relieved to get back to everyday things.*) Tell you what Mrs Peters, why don't you take the quilt with you? It might take up her mind.
- 50 MRS PETERS: I wonder if her patches are in here — and her things. (*They look in her sewing basket.*)
- MRS HALE: Here's some red. I expect this has got sewing things in it (*Brings out a fancy box.*) What a pretty box. Looks like something somebody would give you. Maybe her scissors are in here. (*Opens box. Suddenly puts her hand to her nose.*) Why — (*Mrs Peters bends nearer, then turns her face away.*) There's something wrapped up in this piece of silk.
- 55 MRS HALE: (*Lifting the silk.*) Oh, Mrs Peters — it's — (*Mrs Peters bends closer.*)
- MRS PETERS: It's the bird.

Adapted from Susan Glaspell, "Trifles".
In Drama: A Pocket Anthology edited by R. S. Gwynn,
Pearson Education, Inc. 2006, pp. 272–274.

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE



- (a) What did Mrs Hale notice about Mrs Wright's sewing on the quilt in lines 1-4?

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(2 marks)

- (b) Suggest ONE reason why Mrs Peters says "I don't think we ought to touch things" (line 10).

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(2 marks)

- (c) State TWO things about Mrs Wright's character that are suggested by the dialogue. Use evidence from the extract to support EACH response.

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(4 marks)

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE



- (d) Comment on the effectiveness of EACH of the following stage directions in expressing Mrs Hale's attitude to Mr and Mrs Wright.

(i) "Shakes her head" (line 36)

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(2 marks)

(ii) "Shivers" (line 40)

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(2 marks)

- (e) Explain the role of the women (Mrs Peters and Mrs Hale) in the extract.

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(2 marks)

- (f) Explain the dramatic function of the bird cage in the extract.

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(3 marks)

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE



(g) Suggest a title for the extract. Use evidence to justify your choice.

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(3 marks)

Total 20 marks

SECTION B – POETRY

2. Read the following poem carefully and answer ALL the questions that follow.

The Man Who Finds His Son Has Become a Thief

Coming into the store at first angry
At the accusation, believing
The word of his boy who has told him,
I didn't steal anything, honest...

- 5 Then becoming calmer, seeing that anger
won't help in the business, listening patiently
as the other's evidence unfolds, so painfully slow.

- Then seeing gradually that evidence
almost as if tightening around the neck
10 of his son, at first circumstantial, then gathering damage,
until there's present guilt's sure odor seeping
into the mind, laying its poison.

- Suddenly feeling
sick and alone and afraid, as if
15 an unseen hand had slapped him in the face
for no reason whatsoever; wanting to get out
into the street, the night, the darkness, anywhere to hide
the pain that must show to these strangers, the fear.

- It must be like this.
20 It could not be otherwise.

*Raymond Souster, "The Man Who Finds
His Son Has Become a Thief".
In Collected Poems of Raymond Souster
Oberon Press, 2003, p. 25.*

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE



- (a) Briefly describe what is happening in the poem.

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(3 marks)

- (b) What is the effect of the italics in line 4?

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(2 marks)

- (c) Identify the lines in the poem where the father's attitude to the situation changes and explain why his attitude changes.

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(3 marks)

- (d) Comment on the poet's use of contrast.

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(2 marks)

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE



- (e) Identify the literary device in “guilt’s sure odor seeping/into the mind” (lines 11–12) and comment on its effectiveness.

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(3 marks)

- (f) (i) Describe the father’s character. Justify your answer using evidence from lines 13–20.

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(2 marks)

- (ii) Based on the father’s character, suggest how he might handle the situation with his son after leaving the store.

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(2 marks)

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE



- (g) Suggest another title for this poem. Use evidence from the poem to support your choice.

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(3 marks)

Total 20 marks



SECTION C – PROSE FICTION

3. Read the following extract carefully and answer ALL the questions that follow.

At private lessons one morning, Mr Hinds announced that he was going to raffle a goat — a shilling a chance. Next morning I wrote out the names of the boys on slips of paper. Mr Hinds borrowed my cap, put the slips in, took one out, said, ‘Vidiadhar, is your goat,’ and immediately threw all the slips into the wastepaper basket.

- 5 He led me to the back of the yard. There was a goat. A white one with big horns, tied to a plum tree. The goat looked sullen and sleepy-eyed. Mr Hinds invited me to stroke the goat. I stroked it. He closed his eyes and went on chewing. When I stopped stroking him, he opened his eyes.

- 10 Every afternoon at about five, an old man drove a donkey-cart through Miguel Street where we lived. The cart was piled with fresh grass tied into neat little bundles. We were buying five, sometimes six bundles a day, and every bundle cost six cents. The goat didn’t change. From time to time Mr Hinds asked me with a smile how the goat was getting on, and I said it was getting on fine. But when I asked my mother when we were going to get milk from the goat she told me to stop aggravating her. We bought the neat bundles of grass, the goat ate, and I saw no milk.

- 15 And when I got home one lunch-time I saw no goat.

‘Somebody borrow it,’ my mother said. She looked happy.

‘When it coming back?’

She shrugged her shoulders.

- 20 It came back that afternoon. A man I didn’t know was holding it by a rope and making a big row, gesticulating like anything with his free hand. A lot of people were looking on through curtains.

‘But why all-you want to rob poor people so?’ he said, shouting. He turned to his audience behind the curtains. ‘Look all-you, just look at this goat!’

The goat, limitlessly impassive, chewed slowly, its eyes half closed.

- 25 ‘But how all you people so advantageous? My brother stupid and he ain’t know this goat but I know this goat. Everybody who know about goat know this goat is the most uselessest goat in the whole world.’

*Adapted from V.S. Naipaul, “The Raffle”.
In The Nightwatchman’s Occurrence Book,
Picador, 2002, pp. 361–363.*

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE



- (a) (i) Identify the TWO settings in this extract.

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(2 marks)

- (ii) Who is the narrator of this extract?

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(1 mark)

- (b) What TWO impressions do you get of the narrator? Provide evidence from the extract to support each of your impressions.

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(4 marks)

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE



(c) (i) What image of the goat is created in the extract?

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(1 mark)

(ii) How does the writer create the image identified in (i) above? Support your answer with evidence from the extract.

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(3 marks)

(d) What impression might the reader get of Mr Hinds? Select TWO pieces of information from the extract to justify your answer.

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(3 marks)

(e) Explain ONE way in which the writer makes the extract humorous.

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(3 marks)

- (f) What do you think has caused the man in the extract to be angry? Use information from lines 15–27 to support your answer.

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(3 marks)

Total 20 marks

END OF TEST

IF YOU FINISH BEFORE TIME IS CALLED, CHECK YOUR WORK ON THIS TEST.

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